

Before you automate anything, give it one verdict.

Five are available. The order below is the order of return, not popularity.

Automation backlogs are full of processes nobody has challenged in years. The verdict comes first.

VERDICT 1

ELIMINATE

No consumer, no mandatory anchor, no decision affected. The process stops.

Removes all of the process hours and avoids the automation build entirely.

VERDICT 2

MERGE

A duplicate produces the same output for the same consumer.

One survives. The controls move somewhere real.

SIMPLIFY. REDESIGN.

Simplify: the process earns its existence but not its weight. Keep the spine, cut the ballast.

Redesign: most instances bypass the official path. The workaround is the real process; rebuild on it. You cannot automate fiction.

VERDICT 5

AUTOMATION CANDIDATE

Evidenced consumer. Stable path. Real volume.

And still only a candidate: an applicability gate stands between the verdict and a build.

Automation is the last verdict, not the first question.

The Kill This Process Kit runs the whole method: ten evidence questions, five verdicts, one 90-minute session your sponsor runs, signed memos, and the page that prices the automation you avoided.

Link in the post.